

ARCH-001

Evidence Is Produced. Trust
Is Verified. — The Founding
Architecture of Opus X

DRAFT

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NOTE — Position of this document. ARCH-001 records a founding architectural decision of the Opus X ecosystem: the separation between the parties that *produce evidence* and the trust platform that *verifies, aggregates, certifies, and publishes* it into a Professional Passport. It is the official reference for the role separation, the official evidence flow, and the value separation, and it is cited by the rest of the corpus as the authority on these. It is deliberately framed as a **founding architectural principle of Opus X**, distinct in register from a **protocol invariant** (see §3): the World Skills Protocol does not mandate this separation for every possible implementation; Opus X adopts it as the governing principle of its ecosystem. It refines and locks principles already present across the corpus (WSP-004, OPUS-000/400/600, ARCH-000, ECOSYSTEM-900) without renaming or contradicting any of them. This is a Draft.

Version History

Version	Date	Status	Summary of Changes
0.1	2026-07-10	Draft	Initial publication. Records the founding architecture: the motto, the role separation, the non-self-attribution principle, the official flow, the value separation, and the distinction from a protocol invariant.
0.2	2026-07-13	Draft	Adds the second founding statement — <i>An Issuer owns the learning journey. Opus X owns the professional identity.</i> — the identity dimension of the same separation (§2.2). Adds the [Issuer Name] Progress pattern (§7.4): every Issuer keeps its own internal progression, named for itself, and no Issuer ever recreates a local Passport or a competing professional identity . Adds the multi-Issuer design rule (§4.5): no architectural decision is ever specific to one Issuer. Recorded during Sprint 2 design, when the first Issuer (Commando OS) was brought under this architecture. No change to any existing rule.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This document records, as the official reference of the project, the founding architectural decision that governs how trust is produced in the Opus X ecosystem: who produces evidence, who verifies and certifies it, and who owns the resulting Passport. It exists so that every current and future implementation, feature, and document can be checked against one authoritative statement of this separation.

1.2 Scope

The role separation between evidence-producing parties and the Opus X trust platform; the non-self-attribution principle; the official evidence flow; and the value separation that follows. Out of scope: the protocol objects and rules (WSP), the platform's internal services (OPUS-400), the product experience (PRODUCT), and the framework model (FRAMEWORK).

1.3 Normativity

Informative in the BCP-14 sense — this document defines an *architectural* principle of Opus X, not a protocol conformance requirement. It uses no capitalized normative keywords. Its authority is architectural: it is the reference that Opus X implementations and ecosystem decisions are expected to honor, and it is explicitly held at the level of a *founding architectural principle*, not a *protocol invariant* (§3).

1.4 Prerequisites

ARCH-000 (the architecture overview this specializes), OPUS-000 (the three-pillar platform), OPUS-400 (the services that operate trust), WSP-004 (certification and issuance), and FOUNDATION-000 (the protocol invariants, whose register this document is careful to distinguish itself from).

2. The Motto

The founding architecture is captured in one line, intended as a durable motto of Opus X:

Evidence Is Produced. Trust Is Verified.

Expanded:

Applications, organizations, and certified issuers **produce** evidence. Opus X independently **verifies**, aggregates, and certifies that evidence into a Professional Passport. No application can unilaterally assign trust to its own evidence.

The motto names both sides of the model in one breath — who produces the evidence, and who produces the trust — and it is this two-sidedness that makes it the right founding statement. It is simple, memorable, and it summarizes the entire separation this document locks.

2.2 The Second Statement — The Identity Dimension

The first motto governs **trust**. A second governs **identity**, and the two together are the whole architecture:

An Issuer owns the learning journey. Opus X owns the professional identity.

An Issuer — a school, a training platform, a university, an employer — owns everything about *how a person learns and progresses within it*: the curriculum, the coaching, the missions, the internal progression, the pedagogy. That journey is the Issuer's, and it is valuable.

But the **professional identity** — who this person *is*, professionally, across their whole career and every platform they will ever touch — belongs to the professional, and is held by Opus X.

The distinction, stated plainly:

[Issuer] Progress	<i>"Where I stand at this Issuer."</i>
The Professional Passport	<i>"Who I am professionally."</i>

Together, the two statements answer the four questions on which the whole ecosystem rests:

Question	Answer
Who produces the evidence?	The Issuer
Who produces the trust?	Opus X
Who owns the learning journey?	The Issuer
Who owns the professional identity?	Opus X — on behalf of the professional

3. A Founding Principle of Opus X, Not a Protocol Invariant

This distinction is essential and is stated first, so no future reader conflates two registers the corpus keeps separate.

- **Protocol invariants** (FOUNDATION-000) are the permanent, entrenched properties of the *World Skills Protocol* itself — facts are immutable, trust is never minted, competence is never traded, and so on. They are meant to hold across every possible implementation, for decades, and are practically unamendable. The term *invariant* is reserved for these.
- **This document states a founding architectural principle of *Opus X*** — a governing decision about how the Opus X ecosystem operates trust. It is a major, locked architectural reference, but it belongs to the register of *platform architecture*, not *protocol invariant*.

The difference has real consequences. The World Skills Protocol does **not** mandate, for every conceivable implementation, that evidence production and trust operation be carried by separate entities — the protocol stays neutral about who plays which role, precisely so the model can evolve over ten or twenty years (a future context might legitimately see one entity carry several roles). What Opus X locks is narrower and more durable: not that the roles are always separate entities, but that **trust is never self-attributed** (§5). That formulation protects the ecosystem's integrity and its value model without freezing the protocol into a structural constraint that could age badly.

So: the protocol has invariants; Opus X has founding principles; this is one of the latter. It is locked as the official architecture of Opus X, and it does not purport to constrain the protocol itself.

4. The Roles

The ecosystem separates three roles, plus the object they serve.

World Skills Protocol — the open standard (the language). The WSP defines the common language for representing professional competence: the objects, Frameworks, Skills, Evidence, Certifications, Professional Passports, relations, and protocol rules. The WSP **stores no data, computes nothing, offers no commercial service, and holds no user information**. It is only the standard (WSP-000; FOUNDATION-000).

Opus X — the trust platform (the third party that operates trust). Opus X is built on the WSP and acts as the ecosystem's trusted third party. Its mission: receive evidence from certified platforms; verify their conformance to the WSP; centralize all of a professional's evidence; build and maintain the Professional Passport; compute the indices (Trust Index, Skills Index, Readiness Index, and the rest); certify and digitally sign the Passport; host the Passport; publish a verifiable, shareable Passport; provide the consultation, verification, and integration APIs; and act as the ecosystem's trusted third party (OPUS-000; OPUS-400). Opus X **does not train, coach, or produce evidence directly**. It guarantees evidence's integrity, representation, and verifiability.

Business applications — certified partner platforms (the issuers that produce evidence). A business application (Commando OS first, other partner platforms in time) is a specialized application certified by Opus X. Its mission is different in kind: to train, drill, accompany, coach, assess, observe, produce evidence, and propose certifications. It is a domain-expert application and, in protocol terms, an **Issuer** (WSP-004). A business application **never owns the Passport**; it **contributes** to it. All evidence it produces is transmitted to Opus X through the protocol's APIs.

The Professional Passport — the visible product (owned by the professional). The Passport is the visible product of the whole ecosystem. It is hosted by Opus X, owned by the professional, unique, portable, and independent of the applications that feed it (OPUS-200; §7).

4.5 The Multi-Issuer Rule

No Issuer is ever a special case. The first Issuer is simply the first — a university, an employer, a prop firm, a school, or any conforming platform must follow **exactly the same mechanism**, and be able to join **without a single line of code written specifically for it**.

The design test, applied to every architectural decision:

If a second Issuer were to connect tomorrow, would Opus X need to write anything specific for it? If yes, the design is wrong.

This rule is not a future concern to be addressed later; it is a constraint on the design **today**. An architecture built for one Issuer and generalized afterwards is an architecture that will never generalize. What is being built is not a connector to one platform — it is **the infrastructure that receives, verifies, holds, and certifies evidence from any WSP-conforming platform**.

That generality is what makes Opus X a global protocol rather than an extension of its first partner.

5. The Non-Self-Attribution Principle

The heart of this architecture — the precise thing it locks — is a single principle:

A business application cannot be the sole judge of the trust attributed to its own evidence. The trust carried by a Passport is always the result of a process operated by Opus X.

Concretely:

- A business application (e.g. Commando OS) **may produce evidence** — observe, assess, attest to performance.

- A business application **may propose a certification** — assert that a professional met a standard.
- A business application **may never decide, alone, the final value of the Passport** — it cannot assign, to its own evidence, the trust that the Passport carries.
- **Opus X**, as the trust platform, is what verifies that evidence against the protocol, aggregates it with all other evidence, computes the indices, and builds, certifies, signs, and publishes the Passport.

This is the durable core because it is exactly what must never be violated for the ecosystem's trust to mean anything: a system in which an application could self-attribute the trust of its own evidence would be a system in which trust could be manufactured by the interested party — which is precisely what the ecosystem exists to prevent. The principle guarantees that the trust on a Passport is always operated by a party distinct from, and disinterested in, the production of any single piece of evidence.

Note carefully what the principle does and does not say. It does **not** say that the producer and the trust operator must forever be different legal entities in every possible implementation (§3). It says that **trust is never self-attributed** — that the trust a Passport carries is always the product of an independent verification-and-certification process, never the unilateral assertion of the evidence's producer. This is the formulation that survives future evolution while locking exactly the integrity and value model that matter.

6. The Official Flow

The ecosystem's operating flow is, definitively:

1. **The professional** uses a certified platform (Commando OS today; other certified platforms tomorrow).
2. **The platform produces Evidence** conformant to the WSP.
3. **The Evidence is transmitted to Opus X** through the protocol's APIs.
4. **Opus X verifies, records, and updates** the Professional Passport — verifying WSP conformance, aggregating the evidence, recomputing the indices.
5. **The Passport is certified, signed, and made consultable** by its owner and by authorized third parties.

Every step respects the role separation: the certified platform produces; Opus X verifies and operates trust; the professional owns the result. This flow is the operational expression of the motto (§2) and the non-self-attribution principle (§5), and it is the reference sequence every implementation follows.

7. The Professional Passport

The Passport is the visible product of the ecosystem, and its properties follow directly from the architecture:

- **Hosted by Opus X.** The trust platform hosts and publishes the Passport (OPUS-200).
- **Owned by the professional.** The Passport belongs to the professional, not to any application or platform that feeds it (WSP-005 §4; OPUS-200 §4).
- **Fed by many certified platforms over a career.** One Passport may receive evidence from Commando OS, other training platforms, employers, universities, certifying bodies, and future WSP-compatible applications — across a whole professional life.
- **Survives the applications.** If a platform disappears, the Passport and the already-certified evidence continue to exist. This is a fundamental principle of the architecture (ECOSYSTEM-900 §6; the deletion test, ARCH-000 §9): the Passport outlives any application that fed it, because it is hosted and certified by the trust platform on the open standard, not trapped in the producing application.

7.4 The [Issuer Name] Progress Pattern

Every Issuer keeps its own **internal progression** — its pedagogy, its coaching, its levels, its local experience. This is legitimate, valuable, and entirely the Issuer's own.

By convention, an Issuer exposes that progression under the name:

[Issuer Name] Progress

Examples: Commando Progress · MedSchool Progress · Engineering Academy Progress · Sales Academy Progress.

The rule this pattern enforces — and it is the point:

- The progression is **local**. It serves coaching, pedagogy, and the Issuer's own experience.
- The progression is **never the professional identity** of the subject.
- **No Issuer ever recreates a local Passport, or a competing professional identity.**

The Passport is unique. The progression is local.

The naming matters because names create claims. A platform that calls its internal view a "Passport" is claiming, quietly, to hold an identity — and two identities is no identity at all. Naming it [Issuer] Progress says exactly what it is: *where I stand at this Issuer* — while *who I am professionally* is held, once, in the Passport.

This pattern is given to every Issuer at the moment it joins, so that the question never arises twice.

The Passport's independence from its feeding applications is the product-level consequence of the role separation: because no application owns the Passport and no application self-attributes its trust, the Passport can accept evidence from many sources over time and survive any of them — which is exactly what makes it a lifelong, portable representation rather than one platform's profile.

8. The Separation of Value

The architecture cleanly separates the value each party creates — which is simultaneously the ecosystem's economic model (ECOSYSTEM-100) and a consequence of the role separation.

- **Partner platforms (like Commando) create value by** developing competence, accompanying professionals, and producing quality evidence — the work of building and demonstrating real capability.
- **Opus X creates value by** guaranteeing trust, centralizing evidence, certifying Passports, enabling their verification, and providing the APIs and trust services — the work of making competence verifiable and portable.

This separation of value is the economic expression of *Evidence Is Produced. Trust Is Verified.*: the producers are paid for producing competence and evidence; the trust platform is paid for operating trust. Neither captures the other's value, and neither can substitute for the other — a partner platform cannot self-certify its way to trust, and Opus X cannot train its way to evidence. The clean split of value follows the clean split of roles, and locking one locks the other.

9. What This Locks, and What It Deliberately Leaves Open

For the avoidance of doubt, this document is explicit about the boundary of its own commitment.

What is locked (the official architecture of Opus X): - Trust is never self-attributed; the trust a Passport carries is always operated by Opus X (§5). - Business applications produce evidence and propose certifications; they never own the Passport or decide its final value (§4, §5). - Opus X verifies, aggregates, certifies, signs, hosts, and publishes; it does not train, coach, or produce evidence (§4). - The Passport is owned by the professional, hosted by Opus X, fed by many certified platforms, and survives them all (§7). - The separation of value follows the separation of roles (§8). - Opus X will not drift into a training platform, and Commando will not drift into a Passport platform (§10).

What is deliberately left open (not frozen, to protect long-term evolution): - The protocol does not forbid, for every possible implementation, that one entity carry several roles at once. The WSP stays neutral about who operates which role (§3). - The specific mechanisms of verification, index computation, and certification may evolve (through the platform's normal evolution, and the protocol's through RFC) without touching this principle. - Future roles, platforms, and evidence sources may join, provided they respect non-self-attribution.

Locking the principle rather than the entity-structure is what makes this architecture both firm and durable: it fixes the integrity and value model permanently, while leaving the protocol free to evolve for decades.

10. Consistency With the Existing Corpus

This document introduces no new vocabulary and contradicts nothing; it refines and locks principles already present, and serves as their official reference:

- **WSP-004 (certification and issuance)** already established that the platform does not itself issue; ARCH-001 names the issuers (certified business applications) and the trust operator (Opus X), and the flow between them.
- **OPUS-000 / OPUS-400** already described Opus X as the trust platform with its services; ARCH-001 locks the boundary that those services operate trust and never produce evidence.
- **ARCH-000 §9 (the deletion test)** and **ECOSYSTEM-900 §6 (the Passport survives applications)** are the properties ARCH-001's §7 makes architecturally official.
- **OPUS-600 (Commando OS / Opus X / protocol interactions)** described the layering; ARCH-001 fixes Commando's role as a certified Issuer and business application, distinct from the trust platform.
- **The invariants (FOUNDATION-000)** are untouched; ARCH-001 is careful to sit in the register of platform architecture, not protocol invariant (§3).

Where any future document touches the roles of evidence production, trust operation, or Passport ownership, ARCH-001 is the reference it cites, and ARCH-001 prevails on conflict about this separation.

11. Summary

This document records the founding architectural decisions of Opus X, captured in two mottos meant to endure: **Evidence Is Produced. Trust Is Verified.** — and its identity companion, **An Issuer owns the learning journey. Opus X owns the professional identity.** Applications, organizations, and certified issuers produce evidence; Opus X independently verifies, aggregates, and certifies it into a Professional Passport; and no application can unilaterally assign trust to its own evidence. The decision is deliberately held as a founding principle of *Opus X*, distinct from a *protocol invariant*: the protocol

stays neutral about who operates which role, so the model can evolve, while Opus X locks the durable core — trust is never self-attributed. The roles are clean (WSP the language, Opus X the trust platform, business applications the issuers, the Passport the visible product owned by the professional and surviving every application), the flow is official (produce → transmit → verify and certify → publish), and the value separation follows the role separation. What is locked is the integrity and value model; what is left open is the protocol's freedom to evolve. This is the official architectural reference of the project for the separation of evidence and trust, and all implementations are expected to honor it.

References

Informative References

- ARCH-000 — Opus X Platform Architecture Overview (§9); OPUS-000 — Opus X: The Professional Knowledge Infrastructure; OPUS-200 — The Professional Passport Library (§4); OPUS-400 — The Supporting Infrastructure; OPUS-600 — Opus X, Commando OS, and the Protocol
- WSP-000 — Protocol Overview; WSP-004 — Certification and Issuance; WSP-005 — Passport and Disclosure (§4); FOUNDATION-000 — The Trust Manifesto
- ECOSYSTEM-100 — The Ecosystem Economy; ECOSYSTEM-900 — Long-Term Evolution (§6); FRAMEWORK-WTF-000 — World Trader Framework Overview